Babur has cited a Turkish proverb to capture the essence of this situation:[*]

> Distrust your friend! he'll stuff your hide with straw.

But the cheated Qambar Ali ensured he was freed from Tambal's captivity and reached Aūrā-tīpā on foot, after facing thousands of difficulties.[2]

Meanwhile, Babur came to know that Shaybāni Khān had defeated Baqi Tarkhān in Dabusi and had begun to move to Bukhara. With some trouble woven in mind, Babur decided to continue his leap forward. He along with his men marched from Aūrā-tīpā to Sangzar, through Burka Yilaq. There, the sub-governor, witnessing Babur's power, surrendered and then Qambar Ali was given the place. Affected by Tambal's imprisonment, Qambar had even accepted the mistake and pleaded with Babur to be pardoned.

Samarkand and Decline of Ali Dost

The Samarkand begs under Muhammad Mazid Tarkhān visited Babur as he and his men arrived in Khān Yurti and paid their obeisance. Babur conducted a conference with them and discussed the town's takeover. Mazid informed that Khwaja Yahya (currently controlling Samarkand) held Babur in very good faith and considered him the *Padishah*. Mazid explained that if his consent is taken and things move ahead through goodwill, the town can be easily taken without any fighting.

Accordingly, Babur sent his messenger to Khwaja. But despite Mazid's assertion, Khwaja denied any clear acceptance of having Babur take over the town. Nor did he say anything which could leave them in thorough despair. Babur was confused.

Babur took an unthinkable decision—something he could not have fathomed after the conference with Mazid Tarkhān. He left Khān Yurti and moved to the bank of Dar-i-Gham. He gave a thought and then sent the librarian Khwaja Muhammad Ali to Khwaja Yahya after preaching to him exactly what to say.

This time, the mission was successful. Khwaja Yahya said, 'Let them come; we will give them the town.'[*] Accordingly, Babur's party rode from the Dar-i-Gham straight for the town, at nightfall. But the mission failed. Sulṭān Muhammad Duldai's father, Sulṭān Mahmud had fled from Babur's